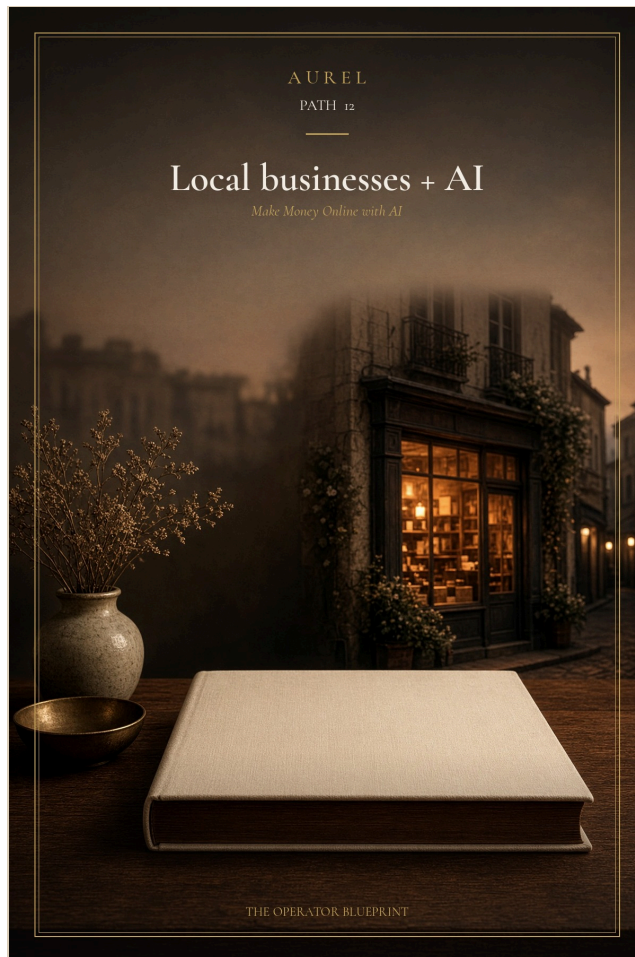




PATH 12

Local businesses + AI

Nearby owners still need pages, replies, and simple videos. Cash while digital compounds.

39 minute read · 8,675 words

Who this is for

You live near businesses that still get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site.

First sale

One local yes and a deposit.

Time to first

3–14 days of walking and writing

Cash window

\$400–\$2,000 packages

Tools

Leave this alone

A one-page PDF of the package, Stripe or e-transfer, your phone, a notes app for the ban list.

City-wide 'we do all AI' agencies. Twelve-month retainers sold before one Friday.

What you are selling

The definition

A named week of work for a nearby owner. Not a 12-month AI transformation. Not a city-wide agency. A package with a date on it: an AI-drafted page plus five posts, delivered by Friday. You edit every draft before they see it. You are the quality, not the model.

Nearby owners still need pages, replies, and simple videos. They get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site that still says opening soon from 2019. They do not need your philosophy about large language models. They need a page that tells a human what the gym costs and five posts that do not sound like a robot moved to town.

You walk in or email with a one-page PDF. Price so one yes covers the week. Cash while digital compounds: this path pays now. The notes from the job become a playbook you can sell later to people not in your town. Do not reverse that order. Do not build the playbook instead of walking.

What this is not

This is not we do all AI for every shop from the highway to the river. That sentence makes you look like a vendor who will vanish. One trade at a time. One package. One week. The first yes is allowed to be a small job. A 12-month retainer is a conversation after they have Friday's files in hand.

This is not a website rebuild, a rebrand, or an ads account. Those are different PDFs at different numbers. If they ask for those on the walk-in, you write the number later. You do not expand the \$800 pack in the hallway.

This is not a chatbot you bolt onto their site and walk away from. Owners do not want to babysit a widget. They want copy they can paste and posts they can publish. Keep the product dumb and dated.

Why this works now

The model drafts a first page in twenty minutes. That was a \$2,000 copywriter week five years ago, and it still looks like a first draft. The gap is the edit: local facts, local claims they can stand behind, a voice that sounds like the owner at the front desk. Most people selling AI locally skip the edit. You do not. That is the whole edge.

Owners already know their site is embarrassing. They have been meaning to fix it since the last New Year promo. Your job is not to convince them the internet exists. Your job is to put a Friday and a number on paper so the meaning-to stops being a story.

Google still sends people to a page with hours, a service list, and a phone number. Five posts still keep a Facebook page from looking abandoned. The tools got cheaper. The owner's Tuesday did not.

Three anti-patterns

Anti-pattern one: the city-wide agency. You print a deck, rent a logo, and pitch every trade in a 40-mile radius. You spend a month on positioning and zero days on a hallway. Leave that alone.

Anti-pattern two: the free trial page. You rewrite their home section as a gift so they can see your quality. They now have your Friday. You have a maybe. The SAMPLE rewrite from public info is the sample. Deposit starts theirs.

Anti-pattern three: the 12-month AI retainer sold on day one. You do not know their approval speed. They do not know your Friday. A retainer is a second PDF after one delivered week. Not before.

The deal you keep

You keep the week cash. You keep the notes. You keep the referral on the same street. You do not keep a 12-month hostage relationship, a city-wide brand, or a reputation for writing claims they cannot stand behind. If those three stay clean, this path compounds. If any one of them breaks, the coffee shop will hear about it before you walk the next block.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This fits you if

This path fits if you live near businesses that still get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site. You can walk into a gym or a cleaner's office without melting. You can write a clear page in English a tired owner will recognize as their shop, not as a template from a different city.

You do not need to be a marketer of record. You need a package, a printer or a phone PDF, and the nerve to follow up the next day. Introverts can email. The work is the same: ten names, five asks, one follow-up.

It also fits if you already know one trade's words. You used to clean houses. You still lift at the independent gym. You have a cousin who runs a two-van shop. Those nouns are the product. Start where you already have phrases.

Skip this if

Skip it if you want to be a city-wide we do all AI agency. That is the thing to leave alone. You will spend a month on a pitch deck and zero days on a hallway.

Skip it if you cannot tell the owner no when they ask you to invent a claim they cannot legally make. Dentists, gyms, and cleaners all have lines. You will not be the person who writes guaranteed 20 lb loss or hospital-grade kill of every pathogen because the model sounded confident.

Skip it if you need to hide behind DMs with strangers in other countries this week. This path is local on purpose. The bus fare is part of the method.

Skip it if you cannot edit. If your plan is paste the model output into their WordPress and invoice, stop. The owner will smell it. So will the next owner on the street.

The honest middle

If you can write but you freeze at a front desk, email the five. Walking still wins in small towns. Mix it. The path is visit or email, not wait to be discovered. If you can walk but you cannot write,

this is not your path until you can sit with a draft for two hours and cut the fake lines.

If you have never sold anything in person, the first five visits are practice, not a verdict. The PDF does the talking. You leave it. You follow up tomorrow. That is the whole social skill.

Skills and time

You need: a clean one-page PDF, the ability to rewrite a home section in a doc, a 20-minute kickoff, an edit pass that kills illegal claims, and a Friday walkthrough that lasts fifteen minutes. You do not need ads knowledge, a design degree, or a CRM.

Time: 3 to 14 days to the first deposit if you actually walk. The week of delivery is 6 to 12 hours of real work if the kickoff was tight. If it is taking 20 hours, the kickoff missed the facts or you are decorating.

Block four afternoons in week one for visits. Block two evenings for the first paid draft. Do not also launch a playbook, a newsletter, and a second trade. One street. One pack.

Two-minute self-test

Answer yes or no. No essays.

Can I name ten businesses in one trade within a 20-minute drive?

Can I write a services page a tired owner would recognize as their shop?

Will I say no to a claim they cannot stand behind?

Will I ask for a deposit before I draft?

Will I follow up the next day without rewriting the PDF?

Four or five yeses: print the PDF this morning. Three: email is allowed, but walk two anyway.

Two or fewer: this is not your path this month. Sell a file or take a remote productized week instead.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this in before you print

Write it on the PDF in a font they can read without glasses: [Page / Google profile / five videos] plus [five posts / five videos] this week. Deposit today, files Friday. [\$400–\$2,000].

If you cannot fill those brackets, you have a vibe, not a pack. Taylor’s version is the default: Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800.

Five sentences that work

Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800. For independent gyms that still have a 2019 New Year graphic up.

Google Business rewrite plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$500. For two-van cleaners who only live on Facebook.

Services page plus five phone videos this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$1,200. For the shop with two locations and a manager who will not write captions.

Home page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$400 founder rate, expires [date]. For your first paid week only, written on the PDF so it cannot creep.

Move-out landing page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800. Same pack, narrower page, same Friday.

Each sentence names the artifact, the count, the week, the money, and who it is for. If you need and also a logo to make it feel complete, you have two products. Split them.

What they get

One page: home or services, written from their facts, edited by you, in a doc or CMS they already use.

Five posts: captions plus a photo brief, or five simple videos from your phone if that is the pack you named.

One round of notes, 24 hours, written.

A 15-minute walkthrough on Friday so they know which button to press.

A written ban list of claims you will not make, so they cannot later say you forgot to promise the moon.

What they do not get

Ads spend. A new logo. A 12-month content calendar. A new website platform unless they already asked and you priced it as a different job. A chatbot. A ranking guarantee. Unlimited rewrites. You do not sell a retainer until you have delivered once.

If they want those, you write a second PDF later. You do not stuff them into Friday for free to close the hallway conversation.

Packaging

One page. Printed and on your phone. Headline, what is in, what is out, Friday, price, deposit, your phone, two sentences of proof if you have any. A sample rewrite from public info, marked SAMPLE, counts as proof.

Do not make a brochure. Do not make a deck. Do not make a contract that looks like a law firm. A one-page agreement lives behind the PDF: deliverable, date, price, claims, who owns the copy (they do, on payment). The PDF sells. The agreement protects Friday.

Name the pack the same way every time. If you call it a content sprint on Monday and a page package on Wednesday, they will wait. Same nouns. Same number. Same Friday.

What done looks like

The definition

Done for the path: one local yes and a deposit. Not a maybe. Not send me something. Money in, date on the calendar.

Done for the week: Friday files they can use without you in the room. The page is in their voice, with their hours, their price range if they allow it, their real service list. The five posts are

scheduled or sitting in a folder with the image brief. You did not paste raw model output. You cut the claims they cannot make.

Fairness test

Read the page out loud in their doorway voice. If you would be embarrassed to hand it to a customer who already knows the shop, it is not done. If a competitor in the next town could paste it onto their site with two nouns swapped, it is not done. If the owner has to ask which file is the page, it is not done.

Would you pay \$800 for this folder if you ran their shop? If the honest answer is not yet, keep editing. Do not invoice hope.

Technical done

Deposit received before you draft.

Kickoff: 20 minutes or a form. Facts, photos they can send, phrases they hate, examples of posts they do not hate, a written ban list.

Drafts they never see until you have edited.

Page in a format they can paste: Google Doc, Word, or directly in the CMS they already use.

Not a Figma they cannot open.

Five posts named by day, each with caption, photo brief, and any link they should include.

Friday delivery in a folder they own, plus the walkthrough.

Balance paid.

A referral ask the same day: Who else on this street should hear this?

A Monday check-in text. Then you stop hovering.

Not-done-yet list

If any of these are true, you are not done. Keep going or name the miss.

Handshake, no deposit.

Raw model output in their Messenger.

Hours missing, parking missing, real service list replaced with synergistic solutions.

A claim on the page they cannot stand behind.

Files in your Google Drive with sharing set to private.

No walkthrough, just a Dropbox link at 11pm Thursday.

No referral ask because it felt awkward.

Ghosting after the posts go up.

Unlimited rewrites still open, Friday never closed.

If you ghost after the posts go up, it is not done. It is a one-star story the next owner will hear at the coffee shop.

Price so one yes covers the week

The range

Cash window: \$400–\$2,000 packages. Taylor's page plus five posts this week sits at \$800. That number should cover your hours, your walking, and the fact that you cannot sell Friday twice.

\$400–\$500 is a founder pack if you need the first case and you will write that on the PDF as a first-seat price with a date it expires. \$800 is the default once you have one sample page made from public info. \$1,200–\$2,000 when the page is a full services rewrite plus five videos, or when the owner has two locations.

Do not invent \$3,500 because a course said premium. You have no proof yet. Do not invent \$150 because you are nervous. Nervous is not a price.

When to raise

Raise after one delivered Friday and a sentence from the owner you can use (with permission). Then the next PDF is \$800 if you started at \$400, or \$1,200 if you started at \$800 and the next job is videos or two locations. Raise because the pack does more or because you have a local sample, not because you got bored.

A retainer, later, can be \$1,200 a month for four posts a week. That is a different PDF. After. Not on the walk-in.

Refunds in one sentence

If the files are not usable as specified on the PDF, you refund the unused half and they keep whatever was already delivered that meets the spec. You do not refund a change of mind after Friday's walkthrough. Deposit is to start, not a souvenir.

Never charge for these

Never charge for a handshake draft. Never charge to think about it. Never charge for claims you refused to write. Never charge a percentage of their revenue. Never charge ads spend you are not running. Never charge a 12-month lump on day one.

Never charge \$0 as a trial. Free is a price. It trains the street.

Worked dollars

One \$800 yes is the week. After a 50% deposit you have \$400 in the account on day one of the job and \$400 on Friday. Two \$800 jobs in a month is \$1,600. A later \$1,200 retainer on one of them is a second till, not a replacement for walking.

A \$400 founder week plus a \$800 second week is \$1,200 in fourteen days if you actually follow up.

Do not discount to win the street. One \$800 yes is the week. Two \$300 maybes is a mess. Local means you might see them at the grocery store, which is why a clean PDF and a clean invoice matter more, not less.

The first 72 hours

Write the one-pager. List ten businesses. Visit or email five. Follow up the next day. The first yes is allowed to be a small job.

Day 1 morning

One trade. Taylor starts with cleaners, then walks gyms with the same pack. You start with one. Learn ten phrases they use: booth, membership freeze, move-out clean, drop-in. Read five Google reviews in that trade. Steal the customers' nouns, not the owners' slogans.

Write the PDF: headline, what is in, Friday, \$800, deposit, your phone, two sentences of proof if you have any (a sample page from public info counts). Print ten at the library or at home. Put the PDF on your phone too.

Pick the ten names. Real businesses, open, in a cluster you can walk or drive without a pilgrimage. Not your friend's Etsy shop in another state. Map them. Morning cleaners. Mid-morning gyms. Do not mix in a dentist yet.

Day 1 afternoon

Build one sample from a real local site that is dusty. Rewrite their home section in a doc. Watermark SAMPLE. Strip fake claims. Put the real cross-street in if it is on the site. You will show it, then offer to do theirs properly with their facts. Do not pretend you already work there.

If you cannot finish the sample in three hours, the page is too ambitious or you are decorating. Home section only. Not the whole site.

Day 1 night

Rehearse the walk-in line out loud once. I am not selling a 12-month thing. One page, five posts, this week, \$800. The PDF is one page. Can I leave it with you? Then stop rewriting it. Sleep.

Day 2

Visit or email five. Walk-in: the line, the PDF, the sample if they ask. You are not pitching for twenty minutes. You are leaving paper. Email: six lines, the PDF, the sample, a Friday date you can actually hit.

Cleaners in the morning because owners are on site. Gyms at 10:30, between classes, not at 5pm when the desk is a riot. Do not visit at lunch and call it a day. Five means five.

Write what happened in the notebook: name, who you spoke to, what they said, follow-up date. That notebook is the CRM.

Day 3

Follow up the next day. In person or one line: I can still start this week if the deposit lands today. Friday files either way. Do not add a second package. Do not redesign the PDF. Walk the next five if the first five were silent.

If someone said later, put a date. If someone said no, ask who else on the block would want Friday files. If someone said send me something, you already did. The PDF is the something. Ask for the deposit or close the thread.

By hour 72 you have: a PDF, a sample, ten names, five asks, five follow-ups in motion. You do not have a brand. You do not have a second trade. You do not have a playbook. You have a week's worth of motion toward one local yes.

The path, step by step

The twelve moves

One trade. Learn their language. Cleaners, gyms, dentists, trades. Pick one. Read five of their Google reviews. The words customers use are the words on the page. They actually showed up is a better headline than synergized cleaning solutions. Write ten phrases on a card and keep it in the bag with the PDFs. You will sound like you live here, because you do.

The named week on one PDF. Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800. Print ten copies. Phone PDF for the ones who will not take paper. Headline in a font they can read without glasses. What is in, what is out, your phone. If the PDF is three pages, it is a brochure. Cut it.

A sample made from public info. Their dusty site, rewritten in a doc, SAMPLE across it. Then: I can do yours properly with your facts. Do not pretend you already work there. Do not use their logo as if you were hired. The sample is a demonstration of the edit, not a sneak delivery.

Ten names, five visits or emails. Hallway, front desk, or the contact form they ignore. You are not a city-wide blast. You are a person on this street. Cluster the names so four visits fit in an afternoon. Shoes that can do that afternoon are a tool.

Follow up the next day. One time, clearly. Owners are busy, not coy. If they say no, ask who else on the block would want Friday files. If they say later, put a date. If they say the nephew does Facebook, use the nephew line from the objections section and leave. Zero follow-ups is how nice PDFs die on a counter.

Deposit. Kickoff. Money, then a 20-minute fact pull: hours, services, prices they will print, photos, phrases to ban, claims they must not make. Write the bans down. Read them back. If they want hospital-grade and they do not have the certificate, the ban list gets that line. Do not start a draft on a handshake.

Draft with the model. Edit like you live here. AI can draft. They never see the raw pass. Cut fake urgency. Cut medical or chemical claims. Put the real cross-street in the copy. Put the real parking note. Put the real name of the owner if they want it. If the model added eco-certified and they are not, you cut it. That cut is the job.

One round of notes, 24 hours, written. They get a folder or a doc, not a live Google Doc you are still typing in. They reply once, in writing, inside a day. Then you ship. Unlimited is how Friday never comes. Put the round on the PDF so this is not a surprise.

Deliver Friday. Folder they own. Page in a format they can paste. Five posts with the photo brief. Fifteen-minute walkthrough. Balance paid before or at the walkthrough, as the PDF said. File names a human can read. Posts in the order of the week. Then you leave.

Ask for a referral to the next owner on the same street. Same day. If this saved you a headache, who else should I walk to before I go home? Write the name in the notebook before you start the car. Walk that name the same week if you can. A referral from a delivered Friday beats ten cold gyms.

Do not ghost. A text on Monday: Any post you want swapped? One check-in. Then stop hovering. You are not their staff. Hovering trains them to treat \$800 as a junior employee. Ghosting trains the coffee shop. One text is the line.

Notes from the job become a playbook. The phrases, the claims you refused, the kickoff questions. That file can sell to cleaners in other towns. Later. After cash this week. Only then, a second week or a retainer. Same pack for the gym two doors down, or a monthly at a written rate. Not a 12-month contract sold on day one. Not a new trade on the other side of the city until this street has seen you deliver.

Log the claims you refused. A running list. This is how you stay out of trouble and how the playbook later teaches. When the next owner asks for guaranteed results, you already have three true lines ready.

Keep the street small until three Fridays exist. Three delivered weeks in one trade is a local reputation. One delivered week and a jump to dentists across town is how you start over at zero, with a thinner sample.

Worked example: Taylor walking gyms and cleaners

Who and where

Taylor lives in a town where the highway gyms have new paint and the independent ones have a Facebook page last updated for a New Year promo. The cleaners are busier than they look. Taylor is not an agency. Taylor has a phone, a one-page PDF, and a week to fill. No following. No case-study site. A library card for the prints.

Calendar, week of the 3rd

Monday morning: PDF written. Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800. In: one services or home page, five posts (caption plus what to photograph), one round of notes. Out: ads, logos, a new website builder. Taylor printed twelve PDFs at the library. Listed ten cleaners and eight gyms, then circled the ten closest cleaners because mornings are when those owners are on site.

Monday afternoon: sample. A rewrite of a cleaner's public home page, SAMPLE watermark, fake claims stripped. The public page said hospital-grade and eco-certified. Taylor cut both. The sample said bonded, move-outs take a day, we text an ETA. Three hours, not a whole site.

Tuesday: four cleaner walk-ins before noon. Two not in. One polite no, nephew does Facebook. One take-the-PDF. Tuesday afternoon: two more, plus two emails to the ones who hide behind a form. Notebook: names, what was said.

Wednesday: follow-ups. One owner not in again. One still thinking. The take-the-PDF owner from Tuesday is in the office. That is the first yes.

The first yes and the artifact

A two-van cleaning company. The owner had been meaning to fix the site for a year. The sample looked like her shop instead of a national franchise. She asked if Taylor could also promise hospital-grade in the copy. Taylor said no: I will not write a claim you cannot stand behind. I will write that you are bonded, that move-outs take a day, and that you text an ETA. \$800. 50% today.

E-transfer on the van hood: \$400. Kickoff in the office: 18 minutes, a list of services, three photos from her camera roll, a ban list. Ban list: hospital-grade, eco-certified, guaranteed same-day, anything medical. Hours, parking in the alley, the real name of the second van.

Shipped artifact: a one-page services rewrite in a Google Doc she could paste into the existing Wix, plus five posts in a folder named by weekday. Posts: a before-and-after (with permission), a move-out checklist, a what we will not do post that built trust, a hiring post for a third van, a Friday availability. Photo briefs a person with a phone could shoot in ten minutes.

The mistake

Taylor drafted Monday night of the job week. The model added eco-certified again and a fake urgency line about slots filling up. Taylor almost left the urgency because it sounded like marketing. Caught it on the morning edit. Also almost sent the draft in Messenger at 10pm so she could see progress. Did not. They never see the raw pass.

Second mistake, smaller: the first walk-in on Tuesday used a twenty-minute pitch. The owner's eyes left. After that, Taylor used the one line and left the PDF. Shorter is the product.

Recovery and the stranger sale

The \$400 deposit was the first stranger sale. Not a cousin. Not a friend who felt sorry. A two-van owner Taylor had not met on Monday. Elapsed from first print to deposit: 6 days. Inside 3–14.

Delivered Thursday night, walkthrough Friday. Balance \$400. Asked for a referral before leaving. The owner named a gym two streets over whose manager also cleaned for her once. Taylor walked the gym the same Friday with the cleaner as the intro, not as a secret. Second pack, same \$800, gym language swapped in (drop-in, freeze, no contract shame). Deposit the following Tuesday: another \$400 in, another Friday on the calendar.

Taylor did not sell a 12-month retainer. Did not open a city-wide AI shop. Notes went into a doc that later became a \$19 playbook for cleaners in other towns. The week's cash was the \$800. The playbook was the compound. The street still had eight names unvisited. That was the next week, not a rebrand.

Copy you can paste

One-pager headline (page hero)

Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800.

One-pager body

You get a services page written from your facts, plus five posts you can publish this week. I draft with AI. I edit every line before you see it. You get one round of notes. You do not get a 12-month contract, a new logo, or claims you cannot stand behind.

50% to start. Files Friday. Walkthrough Friday. Balance on delivery.

Walk-in line

I am not selling a 12-month thing. One page, five posts, this week, \$800. The PDF is one page. Can I leave it with you?

DM or text if they already have your number

Quick note — I still have a Friday this week for a page plus five posts at \$800, 50% to start. PDF is one page. If the timing is wrong, ignore this. If a neighbor should see it, tell me who.

Checkout / invoice line

\$800 — page plus five posts this week. 50% (\$400) due to start. Balance (\$400) due Friday before walkthrough. Deliverable as named on the one-page PDF. One round of written notes, 24 hours. Claims we will not make are on the kickoff list.

Email 1 — cold, six lines

Hi [name] — I rewrote a sample from your public page (attached, marked sample). I can do yours properly with your facts this week: one page, five posts, \$800, deposit today, files Friday. If the timing is wrong, ignore this. If a neighbor should see it, tell me who.

Email 2 — follow-up the next day

Hi [name] — I can still start this week if the deposit lands today. Friday files either way. The PDF and the sample are in the last email. No 12-month contract. If it is a no, a name on this street helps more than a maybe.

Email 3 — after delivery, referral

Hi [name] — files are in your folder and the walkthrough is done. If this saved you a headache, who else on this street should I walk to before I go home? One name is enough.

Refund line

If the files are not usable as specified on the PDF, I refund the unused half and you keep whatever already meets the spec. A change of mind after Friday's walkthrough is not a refund. Deposit starts the week. Email me the miss in one paragraph and I will answer the same day.

Kickoff questions (hand them or read them)

Hours, service list, anything you will not do

Prices that are allowed on a page

Claims I must not make

Three photos I can use

Phrases you hate

Where the page actually lives (WordPress, Squarespace, Facebook only)

Week-by-week

Week 1 — daily

Monday: PDF. Sample page from public info. Ten names. Price on the paper. Print. Map the cluster.

Tuesday: five visits or emails. Notebook after each. Do not redesign the offer between visit two and visit three.

Wednesday: follow up the first five. Walk or email the next five if the first five were silent. Still the same PDF.

Thursday: more follow-up. If a deposit lands, kickoff the same day or the next morning. If not, do not invent a second pack.

Friday: last follow-ups of the week. If you have a job, draft after kickoff, not before. If you do not have a job, list the next ten in the same trade for week 2. Do not add dentists. Do not build a website for yourself.

Saturday: optional. Rewrite the sample if five people said they did not get it. One change. Not a rebrand.

Sunday: off, or the Monday text if you already delivered. Do not spend Sunday on a logo.

Week 2 — daily

Monday: if a job is live, edit pass and ban-list check. If not, five more visits in the same trade.

Monday check-in text only if last week's Friday already happened.

Tuesday–Wednesday: draft, edit, one round of notes if they returned them. Visit the referral if you have one.

Thursday: folder ready. File names a human can read. Do not dump five raw captions into Messenger.

Friday: delivery, walkthrough, balance, referral ask. Walk the named owner the same afternoon if they are two streets over.

Saturday–Sunday: notes into a doc: phrases, claims refused, kickoff questions. That is the seed of the later playbook. Not the playbook. Seed.

If the first yes was a cleaner, the second walk is a gym or the next cleaner, not a dentist in another town.

Week 3

Same pack, full price if you discounted. Write the SOP: kickoff questions, ban list, delivery folder template. A Monday check-in text, then you stop hovering. Second or third Friday on the calendar. Do not hire a walker. Do not open a second marketplace. Do not record a course about local AI.

If two owners asked for videos, that is a second PDF at \$1,200, not a surprise inside \$800.

Week 4

Notes into a playbook draft for people not in your town, or a monthly PDF for the owner who already has Friday files. Do not sell the retainer to a stranger who has not seen you deliver. Do not hire two subcontractors and call yourself an agency.

Count: deposits this month, Fridays delivered, referrals asked, referrals walked, claims refused. If deposits are zero, the PDF is mush or you only visited friends. Fix the ask, not the brand. Then walk ten more.

The quality bar

You are the quality, not the model. If they can tell a chatbot wrote the page, you undercharged their trust and overcharged their Friday.

Below the bar

Raw model output. Fake urgency. Hours missing. A stock photo of a city that is not this one. Revolutionizing the wellness space. Guaranteed body-fat numbers. Hospital-grade with no certificate. Five captions dumped into Messenger at 11pm Thursday. Files they cannot open. A walkthrough you skipped. Ghosting on Monday. A page a competitor could steal with two nouns swapped.

If two files from two different shops of yours could be swapped without anyone noticing, you are selling a template, not a local page. That is below the bar even if the grammar is clean.

Above the bar

Real hours. Real cross-street. Real parking. Real name of the owner if they want it. Service list they actually offer, including what they will not do. Claims cut. Photo briefs a person with a phone can shoot in ten minutes (van in the driveway, 3pm light, no logo overlay). Folder they own. File names a human can read. Posts in the order of the week. Fifteen-minute walkthrough. Monday text. Referral ask. Notes saved.

Above the bar also means you refused a line and offered three true ones. That refusal is part of the product.

Five tests before you send Friday

Doorway test. Read the page out loud as if you are the owner at the desk. Would they say this?

Swap test. Could the gym two towns over paste this with two nouns changed? If yes, add facts until no.

Claim test. Every adjective has a fact behind it, or it is gone.

Folder test. A tired person can find the page and the Monday post without you on the phone.

Walkthrough test. You can teach the publish button in fifteen minutes. If you cannot, the files are in the wrong format.

Fail any one and you are not done. Keep editing. Do not invoice a fail.

What to measure

The first sale is one local yes and a deposit. Measure movement toward that, then toward Friday.

Week 1

Names on the list vs visits or emails. Ten and five is the 72-hour bar.

Follow-ups sent the next day. Zero follow-ups is how nice PDFs die on a counter.

PDFs left. If you talked to five and left zero paper, you pitched instead of leaving the product.

Deposits. Zero or one. One is the path working. Zero is information, not a personality failure.

Day 30

Days from first walk to first deposit. 3–14 is the window. At day 15 with no yes, the PDF is mush or you only visited friends.

Fridays delivered. One is a business. Zero with lots of conversations is a hobby.

Hours from kickoff to Friday files. If it took 18 hours of drafting, your edit pass is too precious or the kickoff missed the facts. Target 6–12.

Referral asked, referral given. One name from a happy Friday is worth ten cold gyms.

Claims you refused. Log them.

Dollars in after refunds. \$400–\$1,600 in month one is a working local path. \$0 with 40 conversations means the price never hit the paper.

Day 90

Delivered weeks in the same trade. Three is a reputation. One is still a start.

Repeat or retainer. Zero is fine. A retainer sold before one Friday is a miss even if the dollars look good.

Playbook notes complete enough to ship later. Not shipped instead of walking.

Second trade: only if the first street is actually done with you, not because you got bored.

Ignore

Brand awareness on the street. Likes on their posts, unless they paid you to run ads, which they did not. Your own follower count. Time spent on a personal website. Number of trades you could theoretically serve. Feelings after a no.

One-line spreadsheet

Date, business, trade, visit or email, follow-up date, result (no / later / deposit), amount in, Friday date, referral name, claims refused (short). That is the whole CRM. If a row has no follow-up date and no result, you dropped it. Fix the row this week, not next quarter.

Objections you will hear

The replies

My nephew does Facebook. Good. This is one page and five posts this week, then you are gone. Nephew can keep the page. You are not replacing their family. You are clearing a backlog.

Can you just show me a free sample on our account? No. Doing the work free as a trial is a mistake this path does not survive. The SAMPLE rewrite from public info is the sample. Deposit starts theirs.

We need to go viral. You are not promising that. You are promising Friday files. If they want ads, that is a different pack and a different number.

\$800 is a lot. One yes covers the week. A cheap website someone never finished already cost them more. If \$800 is wrong, \$400 founder-rate with an expiry date is allowed once. \$0 is not a price.

Put that we are the best in the city / hospital-grade / guaranteed results. No. You will not make claims the owner cannot legally make. Offer three true lines instead.

Can you start and we will pay Friday if we like it? No. Deposit today. Files Friday. Like-it is what the revision round is for, not what payroll is for.

We already have a guy. Good. This is a named week, then I leave. If the guy is delivering Fridays, you do not need me. If the site still says opening soon, I can clear this backlog.

Send me a proposal. The PDF is the proposal. One page, \$800, Friday. If they need a ten-page RFP, they are not this pack. Wish them well and walk the next name.

Can you also do a logo / ads / a new website? Those are different PDFs. This week is the page and the five posts. I can price the rest after Friday if you still want it. I will not stuff it into \$800.

I have to ask my partner. Fine. I will leave two PDFs. I can start this week if the deposit lands by [day]. After that the next Friday I can hit is [later date].

We tried a marketing company and they vanished. That is why this is one week, a deposit, files on Friday, and a walkthrough. You will have the files in a folder you own.

What this path feeds next

Upstream — what has to exist first

You. A town. Ten names. A PDF. You do not need a following, a playbook, or a podcast. If you already sold a playbook to people in other towns, this path is still walking, not DMs.

If you cannot write a page, go do one unpaid rewrite for yourself on a public site and see if you can sit through the edit.

Downstream — where the notes go

Cash this week is the point. Compound is the notes.

The kickoff questions and the claims you refused become a \$19 playbook for cleaners or gym owners you will never drive to. The five-post structure becomes a template you can sell. A local yes who is happy is a case study (with permission, real name, real town).

The same street becomes a retainer after one delivered week. The same pack becomes five videos instead of five captions if they have a phone and a doorway. Do not turn it into a city-wide agency. The next path is a product, not a headcount.

If you also make printables, the cleaner's move-out checklist can be a \$9 page. If you also do long-form, how independent gyms explain drop-ins is a video. Feed those after Friday, not instead of walking.

What not to feed

A city-wide agency. A staff of walkers. Ads for your local AI brand. A second trade while five names sit unvisited. Those starve the street.

Mistakes that kill this path

Ten-plus, and the recovery this week

Doing the work free as a trial. They now have your Friday. You have a maybe. Recovery: stop. Send the PDF. SAMPLE from public info only. If they already have a free page, invoice the posts or walk away. Do not finish the rest unpaid.

Making claims the owner cannot legally make. You will both wear that copy. Recovery: cut the lines today. Send a corrected file. Write the ban list if you skipped it. Apologize once, in writing, without a speech.

Ghosting after the posts go up. The coffee-shop review writes itself. Recovery: Monday text this week, even if Friday was two weeks ago. Then stop hovering. One text is the repair.

Selling a 12-month retainer before you have delivered once. You do not know their approval speed. They do not know your Friday. Recovery: convert it to one named week plus a conversation after. Refund the unused months if you already charged them. Eat the awkward.

City-wide we do all AI positioning. One trade, one pack, one street. Recovery: pick the trade today. Reprint the PDF with one noun. Walk that noun.

Starting the draft before the deposit. Recovery: pause the draft. Send the invoice. If they balk, you learned the job was a maybe. Better now than on Thursday.

Starting a second trade in another town while five local names sit unvisited. Recovery: put the other town on a list dated month 3. Walk the five this week.

Letting them see raw model output. Your name is on the walk-in. The model does not walk in. Recovery: never again. If they already saw it, send the edited version the same day and name what you cut.

Redesigning the PDF after every no. The no was about timing, nephew, or money, not your font. Recovery: lock the PDF for ten more visits. Change the sample, not the business.

Unlimited rewrites. Friday never comes. Recovery: one round, 24 hours, then \$150 for another. Put it on the PDF this afternoon.

Visiting only friends. Friends will be kind and slow. Recovery: ten names you do not eat dinner with. Walk five of them.

Pitching for twenty minutes. Eyes leave. Recovery: the one line, the PDF, the leave. Practice it once out loud tonight.

Hiring someone to walk for you before three Fridays. Recovery: cancel the hire. You need the language.

Tools

The exact stack

A one-page PDF of the package. Headline, in/out, Friday, \$800, deposit, phone. Printed and on your phone. Google Docs or Word, export PDF. Library printer if you need it.

Stripe Payment Link or e-transfer. Whatever the owner already trusts. Invoice with the week's date on it.

Your phone. Camera for samples, maps for the ten names, email, a notes app for the ban list. Five videos, if that is the pack, are also the phone.

A doc for drafts. You write. They receive a clean file, not a chat log.

The model, privately. Drafts only. Never a login you share with the owner as the product.

A notebook or one spreadsheet: the one-line CRM from the metrics section.

A one-page agreement: deliverable, date, price, claims, who owns the copy (they do, on payment).

Setup order

Today: the doc, the PDF, the sample. Today or tomorrow: the payment method, tested with \$1 to yourself if Stripe, or a confirmation you can receive e-transfer. This week: the notebook and the ten names. The model login you already have. Do not buy a new one.

What not to buy

A CRM in week one. A list of ten in a notebook is a CRM. A team. A walker. A new laptop. A city-wide domain. An ads budget for your personal brand. A course on local SEO. A chatbot product you resell. Business cards before the PDF. The PDF is the card.

The \$0 path

Docs, a free Stripe Payment Link or e-transfer, the library printer, the phone you have, the model you already use, walking shoes, a notebook from the dollar aisle. That is enough to take a deposit this week. Do not let paperwork delay the hallway. Do not skip the agreement once money moves.

Checklist

One trade chosen

Ten phrases learned from reviews

One-pager PDF: page plus five posts this week, \$800, deposit today, files Friday

What is in and what is out, written

Sample rewrite from public info, marked SAMPLE

Fake claims stripped from the sample

Ten names on a list, mapped in a cluster

Payment method that an owner already trusts

One-page agreement ready

Five visits or emails in the first 72 hours

Follow-up the next day, one line

Notebook row for every name

Deposit before any draft

Kickoff facts in 20 minutes

Written ban list for claims

AI draft edited by you

They never see the raw pass

One round of notes, 24 hours, written

Friday folder they own, human file names

Photo briefs a phone can shoot in ten minutes

Walkthrough, fifteen minutes

Balance on delivery

Referral ask: next owner on the same street

Monday check-in text

No ghosting and no hovering

Notes saved for a later playbook

Claims-refused log updated

No 12-month retainer sold before one delivered week

No second trade until this street has seen you deliver

Self-test from the who section, honestly answered

FAQ

Gyms or cleaners first?

One trade first. Taylor walked cleaners in the morning because owners were on site, then used a referral into a gym. If you have a membership or a mop, start where you already know the words. Same PDF shape. Different nouns. Default: start with the trade whose owners are physically there in the morning.

What if they have no website, only Facebook?

The page is a Facebook services post or a Google Business profile rewrite. Name it on the PDF so they are not expecting a custom domain. Still \$800 if the work is the same. If it is truly smaller, \$400 and still a Friday. Default: call it Google plus five posts and price \$500 unless the rewrite is a full services page.

Do I need insurance or an LLC?

A one-page agreement: deliverable, date, price, claims, who owns the copy (they do, on payment). Deposit. Local rules on business licenses vary. Do not let paperwork delay the first five visits. Do not skip the agreement. Default: agreement plus deposit this week, paperwork this month, not the reverse.

Can I do this by email only?

Yes if you will actually send five and follow up. Walking still wins in small towns. Mix it. The path is visit or email, not wait to be discovered. Default: walk the cluster you can reach in twenty minutes, email the rest.

What about dentists and medical trades?

Same pack, tighter ban list. You do not write clinical promises. If you are not willing to cut lines, skip that trade. Default: do not start here. Earn two cleaner or gym Fridays first.

How do I handle an owner who wants endless rewrites?

One round, 24 hours, written notes. Then \$150 for another round. Put it on the PDF. Unlimited is how Friday never comes. Default: the PDF says one round before they pay.

Should I hire someone to walk for me?

No. Not until you have delivered three Fridays. The walk is how you learn the language. A hired body with your PDF is the agency you were told to leave alone. Default: your shoes.

Can the five posts be videos?

Yes if the PDF says so. Five simple phone videos, same \$800 or \$1,200 if you are also on camera. Do not surprise them with captions when they expected video, or the reverse. Default: captions plus photo brief at \$800 until someone asks for video, then a second PDF.

What if the first ten say no?

Follow up once. Ask for a name. Walk the next ten in the same trade. Change the sample, not the whole business. Day 14 with zero deposits means the ask is fuzzy or you never mentioned the price on the paper. Default: lock the PDF, new sample, next ten, same trade.

When do I sell the playbook?

After one paid week, when the notes are real. The playbook is for owners you will not drive to. It does not replace the walk this month. Cash while digital compounds — in that order. Default: notes in week 2–4, playbook after three Fridays, not instead of Friday three.

What if I freeze at the front desk?

Email is allowed. Leave the PDF with the desk if the owner is out. Follow up tomorrow. The social skill is the one line, not a TED talk. Default: print anyway, walk two, email the rest.

Do I need a website for myself?

No. The PDF is the site. A sample doc is the portfolio. Build a site after three Fridays if you want a place to send the playbook buyers. Default: no site in week 1.

How do I take payment if they will not use Stripe?

E-transfer, invoice, even a check if that is how the two-van shop pays vendors. Local means you meet them at the rail they already use. Log it. Do not start on a handshake because their

processor is annoying. Default: whatever they already trust, receipt the same day.

What if the owner wants me to log into their WordPress and just do it?

Price that as the same pack if you can finish by Friday, or as \$1,200 if it is a real CMS slog. Get the login after the deposit. Default: deliver a paste-ready doc unless they ask for in-CMS and you priced it.

Can I do this in a big city?

Yes. The cluster is a neighborhood, not the metro. One trade, ten names within a 20-minute ride, same PDF. Default: pick a main street and walk it like a town.

What if I already have a remote productized offer?

Keep it. This path is cash this week from people you can walk to. Do not merge the PDFs. Default: local PDF in the bag, remote page on the internet, no mashup.